Empathy Map – Agricultural Marketplace

Understanding the needs, challenges, and motivations of two key personas driving Egypt's agricultural trading ecosystem.

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Two Perspectives, One Ecosystem

Mohamed El Shenawy

Crop Trader

Focus: Efficiency, speed, supplier network, increasing profits

- Tracks market prices daily
- Negotiates frequently with farmers
- Uses WhatsApp and mobile for communication
- Buys crops from farmers and sells to wholesalers

Hajj Ahmed

Farmer

Focus: Trust, simplicity, fair pricing, financial security

- Relies on personal farming experience
- Asks neighbors for advice
- Uses Android phone, Facebook, WhatsApp
- Sells to local traders

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Mohamed El Shenawy: Crop Trader

Says

- Needs quick access to reliable farmers
- Asks if prices are competitive
- Wants to know crop quality before purchasing

Thinks

- How to expand supplier network
- How to access faster market information
- How to increase transaction volume and profits

Does

- Tracks market prices daily
- Negotiates frequently with farmers
- Uses WhatsApp and mobile for communication
- Buys crops and sells to wholesalers

Feels

- Frustrated by price fluctuations
- Stressed by wasted time searching
- Wants strong market reputation

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Traders Need Speed and Reliable Networks

Speed

Daily price tracking and frequent negotiations require instant access to market information

Network

Expanding supplier networks is critical for increasing transaction volume and profits

Quality

Need to verify crop quality before purchase to avoid losses

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Hajj Ahmed: Farmer

Says

- Prefers voice calls or voice messages
- Does not trust strangers easily
- Wants to know updated market prices

Thinks

- Is the trader offering a fair price?
- How to reduce reliance on middlemen
- How to sell crops at better prices

Does

- Relies on personal farming experience
- Asks neighbors for advice
- Uses Android phone, Facebook, WhatsApp
- Usually sells to local traders

Feels

- Afraid of complex technology
- Responsible for family financial stability
- Frustrated by unclear market prices

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Farmers Need Trust, Simplicity, and Price Transparency

Trust

Does not trust strangers easily; prefers personal connections and recommendations

Simplicity

Afraid of complex technology; needs simple interface

Transparency

Frustrated by unclear market prices; needs updated pricing information

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Key Insights from Both Personas

Speed Matters

Traders need instant access to market information and reliable supplier networks

Trust is Essential

Farmers need verified connections and transparent pricing before transactions

Mobile-First

Both personas use WhatsApp, mobile phones, and basic apps daily

Price Transparency

Farmers need updated market prices to negotiate fair deals

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Opportunity: A Digital Platform Connecting Farmers and Traders

Verified Connections

Build trust through profile verification and ratings

Real-Time Pricing

Provide updated market prices to farmers and traders

Simple Communication

Enable easy voice and text messaging

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Design Considerations

Arabic-First Interface

Design for Arabic speakers with right-to-left layout and local terminology

Voice-First Features

Support voice messages and calls preferred by farmers

WhatsApp Integration

Leverage existing WhatsApp usage for notifications and messaging

Simple Onboarding

Minimal steps to create profiles and list crops for sale

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Next Steps

01

User Testing

Conduct usability tests with both farmers and traders in rural and urban areas

02

Partner Selection

Identify early adopter farmers and traders for pilot program

03

Platform Development

Build MVP with core features: profiles, listings, messaging, and pricing

04

Pilot Launch

Deploy in one region, gather feedback, and iterate quickly

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